



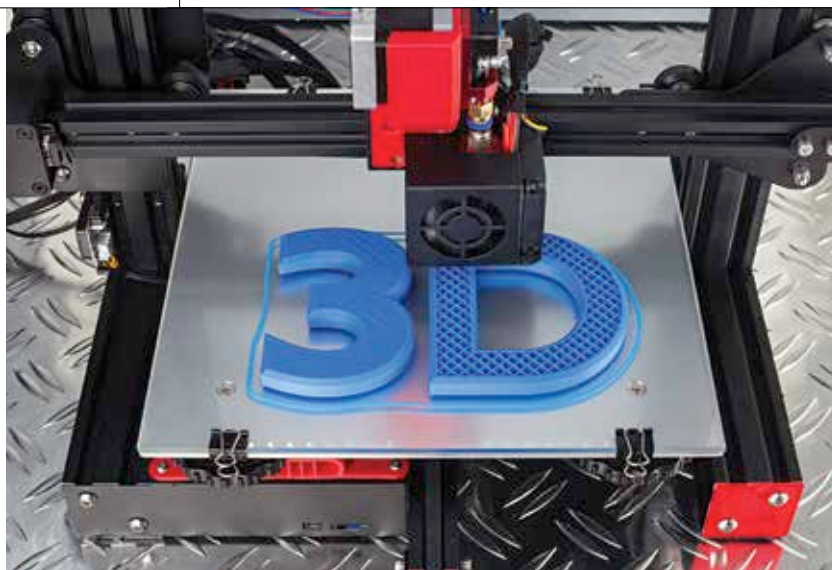
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3D PRINTING TECHNICIAN

Kickstart your career
in this rapidly growing
industry

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The additive manufacturing industry is one of the most rapidly growing sectors where the demand for skilled professionals is constantly surging. There are multiple job opportunities in this industry such as engineers, software developers, material scientists, and technicians. In this article, we will be delving into the career of a 3D printing technician to understand the nature of the work and what qualifications one needs to possess to make this their future career. Before that, let's quickly delve into 3D printing for

the uninitiated. Even if you don't know the exact workings of the technology, chances are that you've at least heard about this lucrative industry. The process of additive manufacturing, also known as 3D printing, enables the creation of three-dimensional objects layer-by-layer using a computer-created or generated design. It is an "additive" process, so layers are deposited upon layers to build the final 3D model. One of the key advantages of 3D printing is being able to produce extremely complex shapes that would be cumbersome to produce by hand. The technology has seen rapid integration in fields such as manufacturing, medical, food, fashion, transportation and other sociocultural sectors. The industry is booming in most western countries, and while India has also seen a large influx of 3D printing applications over recent years, the adoption has been slower comparatively.

WHO ARE 3D PRINTING TECHNICIANS?

3D printing technicians have multiple roles in the industry. They are individuals who assist in designing and programming 3D printed products, ranging from dummy models to full-fledged products. These individuals oversee the printing process and offer recommendations on what kind of products a particular company can produce via these machines. They will work with 3D computer-aided design (CAD) and modelling software, so they must be technically knowledgeable to learn using these software. Also, they must be extremely well-versed in how to operate 3D printers since most individuals who are working in this role will be in a manufacturing or production environment.

Additionally, 3D printing technicians may also provide maintenance for the 3D printing machines, check 3D renders for customers, and run 3D printing tests. When we say provide maintenance, we mean repair, maintain and even clean the machines. So, 3D printing technicians pretty much have their hands everywhere in the entire process.



3D printing technicians work with CAD (computer-aided design) and modelling software

One of the key duties of a 3D printing technician is to create daily schedules for the printers. He/She must be aware of the prints that are required to be completed for customers and will create the schedule on when the project is to be printed in accordance with the schedule. Additionally, 3D printing technicians also need to provide input on ways